

CHILDREN'S STORIES

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ TIER 1 – Storybook is present
- ☐ TIER 2 – Documentation portfolio is present and the story is 1999 words or less (verified on cover page and in portfolio)
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

TIER 1 – STORYBOOK (130 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Story Narrative (X3)	Narrative is poorly written; there is little apparent purpose; it is lacking a coherent theme and storyline.	Narrative's purpose is clear, with a focused theme and storyline; the narrative has good pacing and development of characters and events.	Narrative is extremely well written with a clear purpose; storyline is fast paced and exciting; the details are rich and enchanting.	
Illustrations (X3)	Artisanship of the illustrations reflects little technical skill; illustrations add little value to the story's narrative, storyline, and/or theme.	Artisanship of most illustrations reflects good technical skill; illustrations add to the story's narrative, storyline, and theme.	Artisanship of illustrations is excellent, reflecting sophisticated technical skills; illustrations enhance the story's narrative, storyline, and theme, and they are of high esthetic quality.	
Book Construction and Concept (X3)	Book construction demonstrates little or no creativity or innovation; minimal consideration is given to basic design principles and book construction; book is poorly constructed or is not bound.	Construction of the book is of good quality and demonstrates some degree of creativity and innovation and an understanding of basic design principles; adequate choice of materials was used in its construction.	Book is designed with attention to detail; construction is of high quality and demonstrates a thorough understanding of design principles; an excellent choice of materials was used in the construction of the book.	
Impact (X3)	Story (narrative, with the illustrations) is lacking in purpose and coherence; it is not very interesting; it lacks artistic, and/or instructional, and/or social value.	Story (narrative, with the illustrations) reflects a purpose and incorporates artistic, instructional, and social value; it is somewhat compelling and entertaining.	Story (narrative, with the illustrations) is beautifully told; it is compelling, entertaining, purposeful, and it reflects high artistic, instructional, and social value.	
Theme (X1)	The annual theme is not addressed.	The annual theme is somewhat addressed but doesn't contribute to the effectiveness of the overall design.	The annual theme is addressed and contributes to the effectiveness of the overall design.	
TIER 1 – STORYBOOK SUBTOTAL (130 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: _____

TIER 1 – SUBTOTAL (130 points)

TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (80 points)

CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	Record scores in the column spaces below.
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio is missing one (1) or two (2) components and/or is loosely organized.	Portfolio has all required components in order and is well organized.	
Purpose of Story (X1)	Story's intent, storyline, and theme are poorly explained and/or the intended audience is not identified.	Story's intent, storyline, theme, and intended audience are adequately explained.	Story's intent, storyline, theme, and intended audience are complete and well explained.	
Photographic Verification (X1)	Photographic verification is very unorganized or is missing.	Photographic verification is somewhat disorganized and is missing a few components; the process is somewhat outlined.	Photographic verification has all components and is well organized; the process is clearly outlined; there is photographic verification of book construction and binding process.	
Field Test Summaries (X1)	Summaries are poorly organized and/or incomplete.	Summaries are adequately detailed and organized and contains most of the required components, including a record of the field tests.	Summaries are well documented and contains all the required components, with special attention given to field tests.	
Research and Project Summary (X2)	Summary of the research, design, and writing process is poorly done and/or is incomplete.	Summary of the research, design, and writing process is generally clear and complete.	Summary of the research, design, and writing process is very well written, detailed, clear, and complete.	
Tools and Software (X1)	Lists are missing several components, and/or they are unorganized.	Most components are included; the lists are generally organized and complete.	All components are included and organized in the lists.	
Research Base (X1)	There are few references listed, and/or the references listed show little relevance to the project's goal; sources lack credibility.	There are a sufficient number of references listed, with some credible references.	Many credible and high-quality references are listed, reflecting research in writing and illustrating for children, and in child development.	
TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (80 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: _____

Story length violation: For stories exceeding 1500 words, a deduction of 5 points will be incurred for every 100 words more than 1500 and up to 2000. Stories of 2000 words or greater will be disqualified. Example: 1600 – 1699 words, 5 points; 1700 – 1799 words, 10 points; 1800 – 1899 words, 15 points; 1900 – 1999 words, 20 points; 2000 words and above, disqualified.

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (210 points)

SEMIFINAL INTERVIEW (30 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Knowledge (X2)	Participants seem to have little understanding of the concepts in their project; answers to questions may be vague.	Participants exhibit a general understanding of the concepts in their project.	Participant shows clear evidence of a thorough understanding of their project.	
Articulation (X1)	Communication of the design process is unclear, unorganized, and/or illogical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are not evident.	Communication of the design process is somewhat logical and clear; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are somewhat evident.	Communication of the design process is clear, concise, and logical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are clearly evident.	
SEMIFINAL INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (30 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (30 points)				
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. TOTAL (240 points)				

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____